

PREPARED FOR KRU · CO-FOUNDER, UMBRA

Private payroll. Clear accountability.

From Fahd Kotb, Founder of PrivateDAO. A commercial product proposal for turning private settlement into a complete, verifiable payroll workflow for organizations.

“Umbra protects the payment. PrivateDAO protects and verifies the payroll process.”

PrivateDAO × Umbra · Strategic partnership and investment brief

Payroll is a trust problem, not only a payment problem.

Organizations need to pay accurately and on time, but every payroll run also carries sensitive employee information, approval risk, reconciliation work, and audit pressure.

Too much exposure

Spreadsheets, exports and payment files can reveal more employee information than an auditor or board actually needs.

Too little assurance

Approvers need confidence that policy, deductions, budget and payout totals were handled correctly.

Manual proof

Finance teams repeatedly assemble evidence after the fact, slowing close and creating avoidable questions.

The market needs privacy without losing operational confidence.

ONE CONTROLLED WORKFLOW

Run payroll privately. Prove it simply.

PrivateDAO turns payroll preparation, policy checks, approvals, settlement and evidence into one understandable operating flow.

Private by default

Employee-level data stays protected.

Policy-led

Rules are applied before money moves.

Proof-ready

Share a result without sharing the payroll file.

A clear path from preparation to proof.

01

Prepare

Add recipients, amounts and the payroll period in a focused workspace.

02

Apply policy

Calculate taxes and deductions using a defined, reviewable policy.

03

Approve

Keep review and authorization visible before settlement begins.

04

Settle privately

Use the selected private payment rail for the approved batch.

05

Share proof

Give an auditor a simple link to the verified outcome.

The product is designed for a finance operator, not a blockchain operator.

Three strengths, one business outcome.

PrivateDAO

Owns the business workflow.

Payroll records, tax and deduction policy, approvals, reconciliation, audit trail and the user experience.

Umbra

Protects the movement of funds.

A privacy layer for settlement so sensitive payment relationships and amounts are not unnecessarily exposed.

Blind Verification

Proves the result without revealing the source.

It confirms approved claims while keeping employee-level payroll data private.

Umbra makes the payment private. PrivateDAO makes the whole process accountable.

SHAREABLE VERIFICATION

One link. No payroll leak.

A finance lead can share a public or scoped proof link that answers the important questions without handing over employee names, salaries, addresses or individual tax records.

Policy satisfied

Totals reconciled

No duplicate payouts

Settlement matched

Timestamped record

Payroll verified

The approved payroll process matched its policy and settlement evidence.



Employee-level information is not disclosed.

Why this can win a category.

Privacy plus accountability

Most tools optimize for payment operations or privacy. PrivateDAO connects privacy with a credible business proof.

Process assurance, not just transfer

The value sits before payment, during approval and after settlement, where finance teams actually carry risk.

Portable evidence

A recipient can verify the agreed claims through a simple link, without gaining access to the underlying payroll.

Composable commercial platform

The same verification foundation can serve treasury, governance, auctions and other sensitive workflows.

Built for organizations where trust is operational.

Privacy-conscious teams

Pay employees and contractors while limiting unnecessary disclosure of compensation data.

DAOs and digital organizations

Coordinate contributors, approvals and treasury policy with evidence that can travel beyond the core team.

Finance and operations

Reduce reconciliation friction and make review easier at the end of every payroll cycle.

Initial wedge: organizations that already understand the cost of sensitive operational data being spread across files, wallets and inboxes.

Revenue follows recurring payroll activity.

PrivateDAO can monetize the workflow at the moments that create durable value for customers.

Payroll usage

Per run, per recipient or volume-based pricing aligned to recurring operations.

Verification

Premium proof scopes, audit packs and higher assurance workflows.

Enterprise

Policy controls, role management, retention, support and integration services.

The model is software revenue around repeatable financial operations, not speculative token economics.

Pricing, traction and revenue figures should be populated only from verified commercial data.

Payroll is the first high-value workflow in a wider trust platform.

PRIVATE TREASURY

Control spending

Approvals, budgets and operational evidence.

PRIVATE GOVERNANCE

Coordinate decisions

Private choices with accountable outcomes.

PRIVATE AUCTIONS

Run fair bids

Confidential bidding with verifiable results.

AGENT MARKETPLACE

Automate services

Machine-to-machine discovery and execution.

A shared commercial language around privacy, proof and coordination gives PrivateDAO more than one product wedge.

PRIVATEDAO × UMBRA

Infrastructure becomes a product when the business workflow is complete.

A focused vertical where both companies contribute indispensable value.

Umbra

Private movement of funds and settlement primitives.

PrivateDAO

Payroll logic, policy, approvals, reconciliation and portable proof.

Shared upside

A repeatable enterprise workflow that can become a reference product for privacy infrastructure.

Invest in the business layer around private settlement.

PrivateDAO is not positioning itself as a generic payroll interface. It is building the operating layer that makes privacy infrastructure usable inside a recurring, high-trust business process.

Recurring workflow

Payroll repeats every cycle, creating a natural path to usage-based and enterprise revenue.

Trust as a product

Approvals, policy checks and proof make privacy easier to buy inside finance operations.

Expansion surface

The same foundation extends to treasury, governance, auctions and agent-operated workflows.

The opportunity is to make Umbra-powered privacy something organizations operate with, not merely something developers integrate.

What a PrivateDAO × Umbra collaboration can unlock.

01

Reference product

Co-develop a payroll deployment that demonstrates private settlement in a real business workflow.

02

Design partner

Align the integration with Umbra's privacy primitives and product direction.

03

Pilot motion

Bring a small number of privacy-conscious organizations from demo to controlled pilot.

04

Platform expansion

Reuse proof, policy and workflow infrastructure across additional PrivateDAO product lines.

A partnership creates a clearer path from protocol capability to customer adoption.

Designed for a credible path to production.

Customer experience

Simple preparation, clear policy review, approval visibility and shareable proof.

Trust boundary

Client-side privacy is paired with server-side lifecycle controls and evidence binding.

Network discipline

Devnet demonstrations are labeled as Devnet. Mainnet claims require separate verified production evidence.

The product earns trust by being precise about what is private, what is proven and what is still being validated.

This brief intentionally avoids unsupported claims about tax compliance, live Mainnet settlement, customer adoption or revenue.

A complete Devnet proof path is now demonstrable.

The product has been exercised as a real payroll workflow, not a static screen: three recipients, deterministic policy calculations, approval, private settlement, reconciliation and a shareable verification artifact.

3 / 3 settled

All three Umbra Devnet settlement transactions reached finalized confirmation.

0 duplicates

Reconciliation confirmed the expected count, totals and unique settlement signatures.

Groth16 proof

The payroll commitments were verified and bound to the settlement evidence.

Public proof link

Independent HTTP verification returned an active record without exposing employee-level data.

Evidence-based progress: a complete Devnet demonstration, clearly labeled as Devnet and ready for the next controlled validation gate.

A PROPOSAL FOR KRU AND UMBRA

Make payroll private. Make trust portable.

PrivateDAO is ready to turn private settlement into a customer-facing operating product: simple for finance teams, valuable for Umbra, and extensible across a wider trust platform.

Let's build the reference workflow for private payroll together.

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